

Options for the Development of National Standards and Guidelines for Animal Welfare

The AWTG are continuing discussions on the staged approach to improvements to the standards development process.

Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Livestock at Processing Facilities and Establishments

AWTG 25-03 noted an update from Queensland that jurisdictions continue to work collaboratively on the third draft of the Australian Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Livestock at Processing Facilities and Establishments.

Australian Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Land Transport of Livestock – horses

AWTG 25-03 noted an update from Queensland that ministers continue to work towards national endorsement of amendments to the Australian Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines – Land Transport of Livestock to improve the welfare of horses.

Pig Welfare

The AWTG discussed a proposal from Australian Pork Limited regarding an industry funded project on improving animal welfare for pigs.

Virtual Fencing Technology

AWTG 25-03 noted an update from the Commonwealth that feedback from the stakeholder reference group on the draft Australian Animal Welfare Guide for Virtual Fencing (guide) has been considered and incorporated where practical. This concludes the development process. The finalised guide will be circulated to AWTG members for endorsement.

Implementation of the Australian Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Poultry into state and territory legislation

AWTG 25-03 noted an update from jurisdictions on their progress towards implementation.

Renewed Australian Animal Welfare Strategy (AAWS)

AWTG 25-03 noted an update from the Commonwealth on consultation for the first two chapters of the renewed Australian Animal Welfare Strategy (AAWS) – Aquatic Animals, and Livestock and Production – which has included a public Have Your Say survey, a stakeholder Roundtable and a series of workshops commencing in May to commence chapter development. The AWTG continues its governance role.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/animal/welfare/awtg/communique-may-2025>